04-05 第一篇

The Surprising Link Between Smell and Memory

Have you ever caught a whiff of rain on dry pavement or the scent of old books and suddenly been flooded with a vivid memory from years ago? This is not just a coincidence. [1] When you smell something, the information goes directly to the brain's olfactory bulb, which sits very close to the hippocampus—the area responsible for forming and storing memories. Because of this close connection, smells can trigger memories more powerfully than sights or sounds.

Scientists call this the "Proust effect," named after the French writer Marcel Proust. [2] In his famous novel, he described how the taste and smell of a small cake dipped in tea brought back detailed childhood memories. Today, researchers use this idea to study why certain scents can make past experiences feel almost real again. Some therapists even use smells to help patients recall forgotten events or cope with stress.

Not all smells create equally strong memories. [3] The most powerful scent-memory links often form during our teenage years and early adulthood, when our brains are still developing and emotions run high. Smells connected to strong feelings—like a first date, a family holiday, or a moment of achievement—tend to stick with us for decades. This is why the perfume your mother wore or the smell of your childhood home can feel so meaningful.

Businesses have noticed this power too. [4] Hotels, shops, and even hospitals sometimes add subtle scents to their environments to create a certain mood or help people feel more relaxed. For example, the smell of lavender is often used to calm nerves, while the scent of fresh bread might make a store feel more welcoming. The goal is not to trick people, but to use smell in a positive way that supports well-being.

[5] Whether you are designing a room, choosing a gift, or simply noticing the smells around you, understanding this connection can enrich your daily life. Next time a familiar scent brings back a memory, take a moment to enjoy it—you are experiencing one of the brain's most remarkable abilities.

选项

A. In the end, our sense of smell is a bridge between our past and present. B. The brain processes smells in a unique way that connects them closely to our memories. C. For this reason, some places use scent as a tool to influence how we feel. D. His story showed that a simple smell could unlock memories buried deep in the mind. E. They found that memories linked to strong emotions and key life stages stay the longest. F.

Studies suggest that memories formed during important or emotional moments are most likely to last.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] B [2] D [3] F [4] C [5] A

深度解析

- **[1] B**：
  - **线索**：机制解释与因果衔接。空前问句引出"smell→memory"现象并否定"coincidence"，空后具体描述"information goes directly to the olfactory bulb...close to the hippocampus"。B选项"The brain processes smells in a unique way that connects them closely to our memories"（大脑以独特方式处理气味，使其与记忆紧密相连）概括神经机制，"connects them closely to our memories"与空后"olfactory bulb...close to the hippocampus"形成因果呼应，解释为何气味能如此强烈地唤醒记忆。
- **[2] D**：
  - **线索**：例证展开与承上启下。空前引入"Proust effect"及作家Marcel Proust，空后"he described how the taste and smell of a small cake dipped in tea brought back detailed childhood memories"。D选项"His story showed that a simple smell could unlock memories buried deep in the mind"（他的故事表明，一个简单的气味能唤醒深埋心底的记忆）中"His story"指Proust的作品，"unlock memories buried deep"与空后"brought back detailed childhood memories"完美对应，衔接"Proust effect"的文学例证。
- **[3] F**：
  - **线索**：限定条件与递进展开。空前总述"Not all smells create equally strong memories"，空后具体说明"most powerful...during teenage years and early adulthood...Smells connected to strong feelings...tend to stick with us"。F选项"Studies suggest that memories formed during important or emotional moments are most likely to last"（研究表明，在重要或情感时刻形成的记忆最可能持久）与空后形成递进：F提出"important or emotional moments"，空后展开为"teenage years""strong feelings""first date, family holiday"等具体情形，逻辑顺畅。
- **[4] C**：
  - **线索**：应用转换与例证引入。空前指出"Businesses have noticed this power"，空后举例"Hotels, shops, hospitals...add subtle scents...lavender...fresh bread"。C选项"For this reason, some places use scent as a tool to influence how we

feel"（正因如此，一些场所将气味作为工具来影响我们的感受）中"For this reason"承接前文气味的记忆与情感力量，"use scent as a tool"与空后"add subtle scents""create a certain mood"完美呼应。

- **[5] A**：
  - **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后"Whether you are designing...choosing...or simply noticing...understanding this connection can enrich your daily life...take a moment to enjoy it"。A选项"In the end, our sense of smell is a bridge between our past and present"（归根结底，嗅觉是连接我们过去与现在的桥梁）用"In the end"总结，"bridge between past and present"与全文"smell→memory"主题及空后"enrich your daily life""enjoy it"形成情感升华。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **E. They found that memories linked to strong emotions and key life stages stay the longest.**：与空[3]前后"strong feelings""teenage years"高度相关，易被误选。[3]空前为"Not all smells create equally strong memories"，空后需承接"哪些记忆更强"的限定。E用"They found"开头，但前文无明确"they"指代（[3]前段讲Proust与研究者，非同一句）。F用"Studies suggest"更中性，且"important or emotional moments"与空后"strong feelings""key life stages"覆盖更自然。E属"语义相近但衔接稍弱"型干扰——"key life stages"与"teenage years and early adulthood"有重叠，但F的"most likely to last"与空后"tend to stick with us for decades"更贴合。